

Internal Alignment

Charting a Path to Success



WHAT WE'LL COVER TODAY



Internal Role of Account Managers

Understand the importance of the boundary spanning role.



What Alignment Truly Means

Define alignment and understand the factors that drive cooperation



How to Create Internal Alignment

Tactics to develop internal networks, trust and commitment.

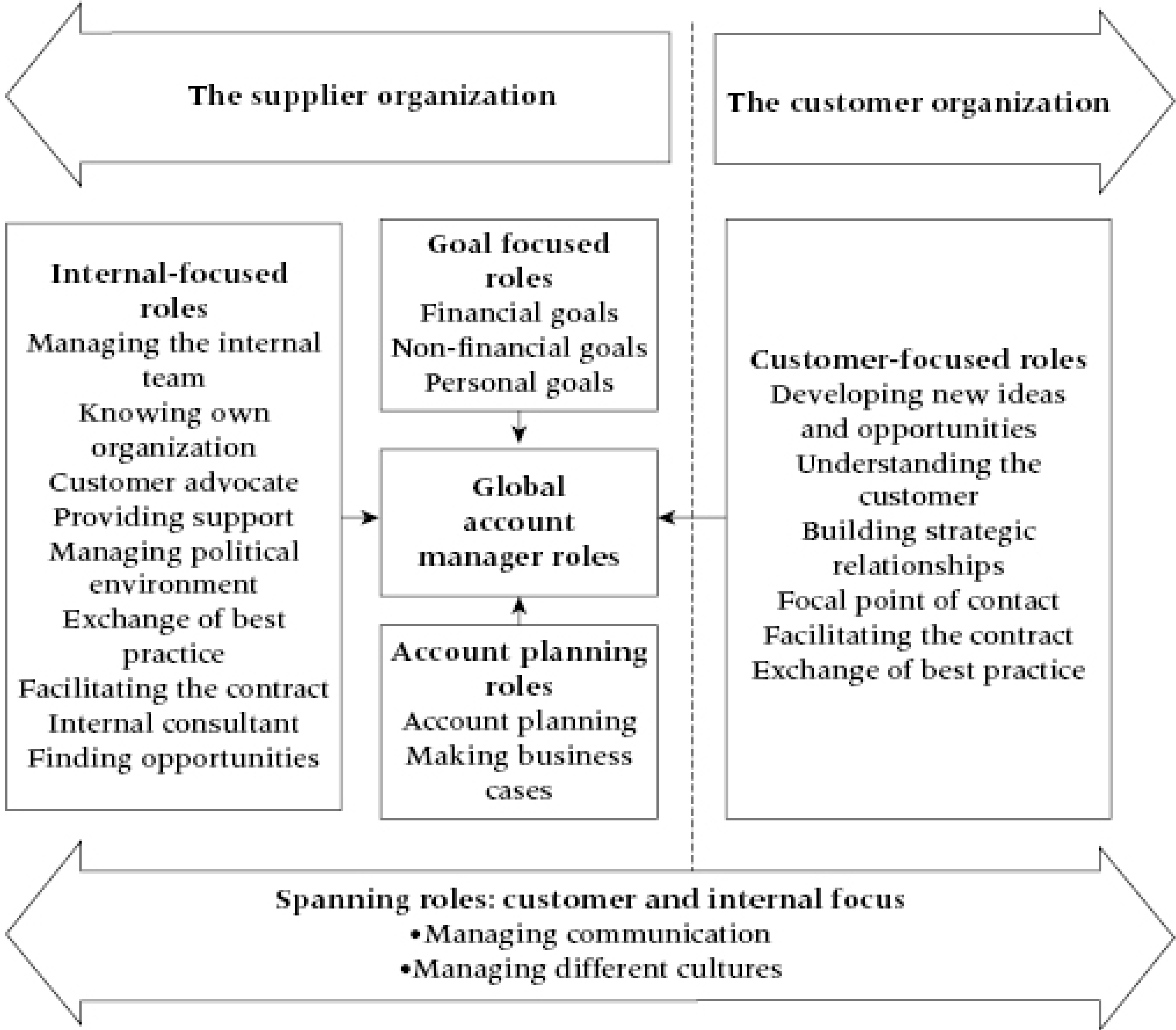
THE IMPORTANCE OF SPANNING BOUNDARIES

Account management requires extensive interaction with internal teams and stakeholders and the ability to influence their decisions and behaviours.

CONNECTING STAKEHOLDERS



BOUNDARY SPANNING



Account managers are the interface between an organization's internal and external networks.

- Develop activities that create value for partners and the organization.
- Mobilise resources
- Coordinate efforts and complex processes.
- Manage communication.
- Improve the fit between offer and need.
- Account managers have low hierarchical power, so must develop influence.



ESSENTIAL SKILLS SETS

Think like a manager

- ✓ **Understand organizational priorities.** Partner and company knowledge, industry knowledge and how these interact.
- ✓ **Partner planning.** Strategic thinking, financial acumen and value insights.
- ✓ **Solution development.** Co-creation, communication, influencing and negotiation skills.
- ✓ **Multi-functional leadership.** Interpersonal skills, culture knowledge, sensitivity, empathy.
- ✓ **Relationship management.** Accountability for business outcomes, process discipline.

IMPLICATIONS FOR YOU



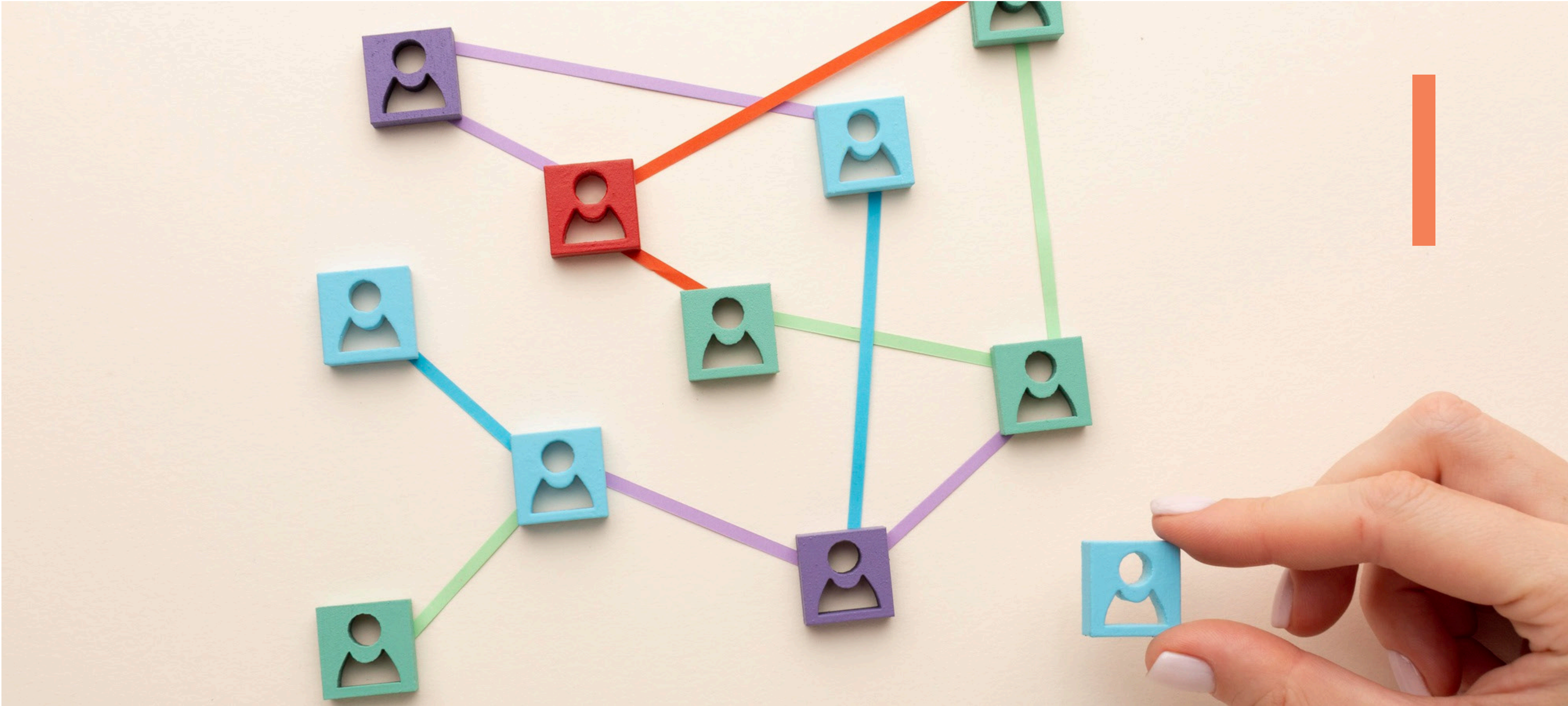
- **Strategic positioning.** Is the account management role and level of authority understood in the wider organization?
- **Boundary and scope.** Account managers must lead and manage internal teams that do not report to them. Does organizational processes support that way of working?
- **Development.** The skills required for account management are complex. Are you developing your political and entrepreneurial capabilities?

INTERNAL ALIGNMENT

What Does Internal Alignment Mean?

Understand the links between the partner side and your business objectives, potential impact and ways to align.

**CONNECTING
THE DOTS**

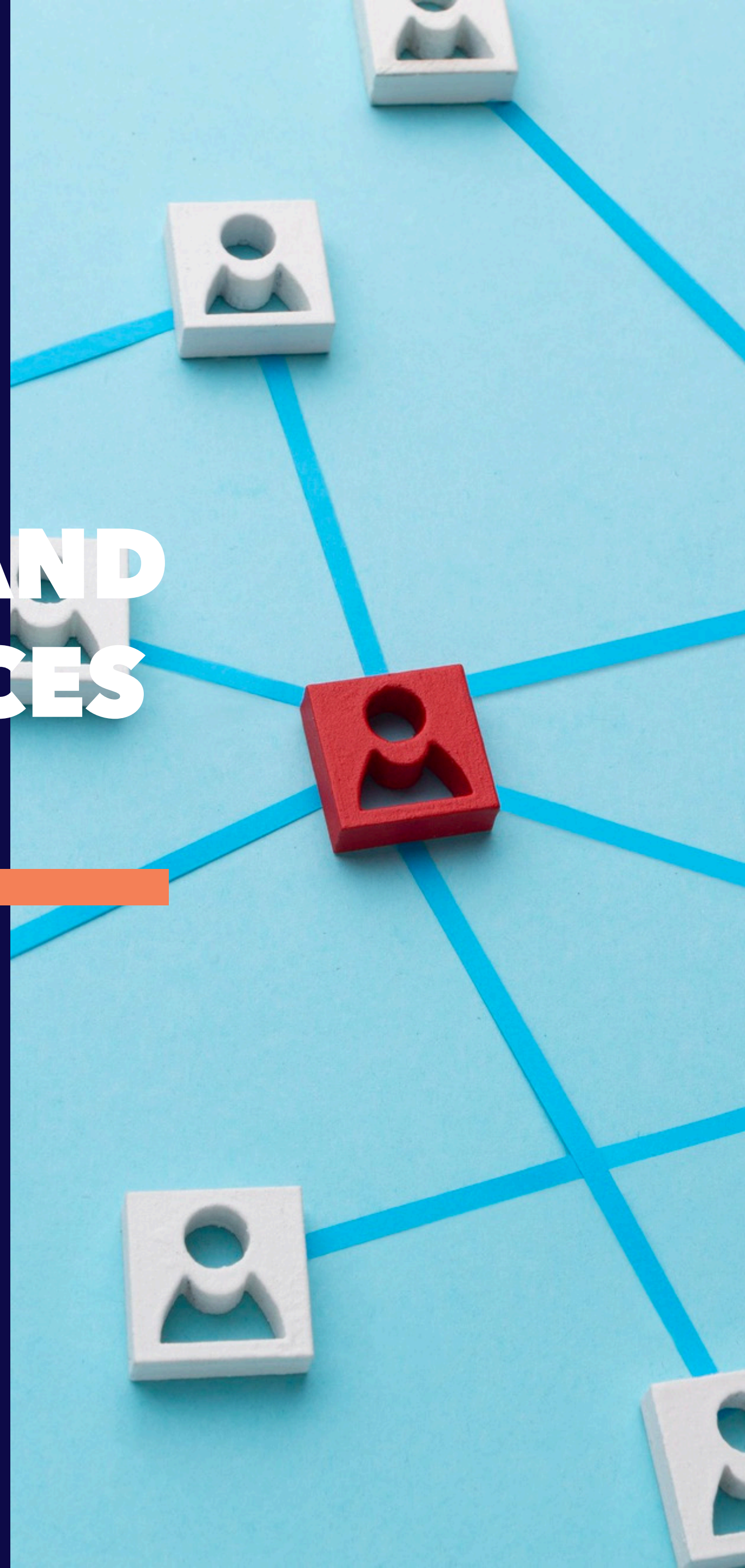


TYPES OF ALIGNMENT



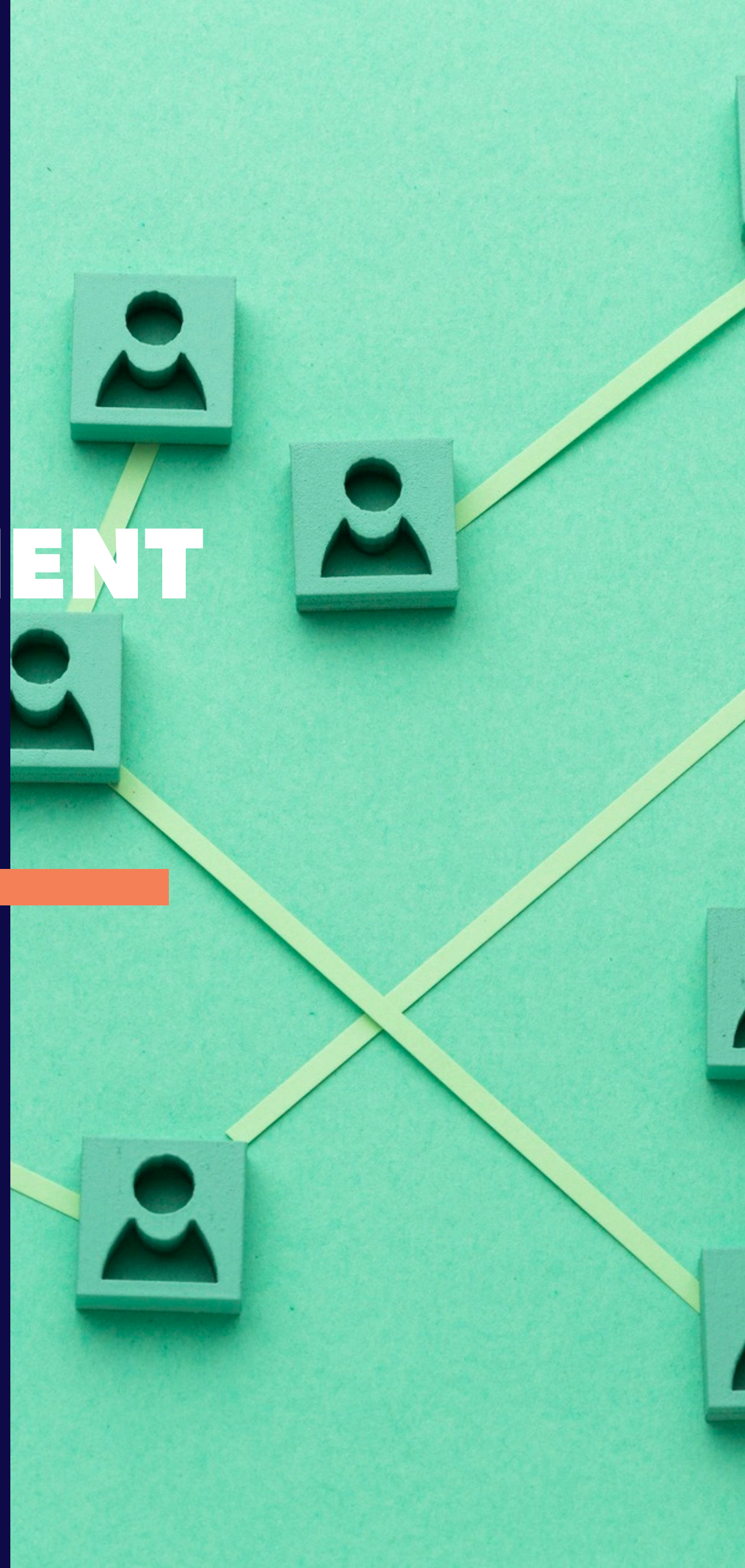
- Hierarchical.** Collaborate with colleagues who are at higher or lower reporting levels than you.
- Functional.** Colleagues from different business units whose activities support your partners.
- Geographic.** Activities and decisions made across borders.
- Dedication.** Internal networks may dedicate their entire time, or only some of it, to supporting your partners.

UNDERSTAND DIFFERENCES



- **Formal structures.** How much structure and process do other teams have compared to you?
- **Time.** Are other teams more short-term or long-term focused?
- **Goals.** How do other teams' goals compare to yours? Similar, different, or in conflict?
- **Motivation.** Are other teams driven by achievement, power or social rewards?
- **Requisite.** To what extent are other teams required to work with you, if at all?

COMMITMENT & TRUST



Commitment. When your internal stakeholders believe the ongoing relationship is important and worth their efforts to maintain it.

Trust. When your internal stakeholders have confidence in your reliability and integrity.

No opportunism. Don't exploit or take advantage of opportunities or situations.



INFLUENCE, NOT AUTHORITY

Motivate internal teams towards common goals and obligations.

- ✓ **Cooperation by influence.** Need to obtain buy-in for partner strategies through persuasion.
- ✓ **Minimise friction.** Reduce conflict to optimise internal cooperation.
- ✓ **Proactive.** Develop and engage internal networks so they are ready when you need them..
- ✓ **Communication.** Collaborate and communicate with stakeholders.
- ✓ **Resources management.** Effectively and efficiently allocate and coordinate internal resources.



Bridging

Information sharing and communication.

Amplification

Focus on core values and amplify them. Inspire and motivate.

Extend

Incorporate other interests and points of view.

Transform

Redefine what it means for internal stakeholders to participate in your world.





KAMGuru helps you to develop profitable partnerships with your most important customers.

Our work is built around the “first rule of business” i.e. “look after your most important customers before someone else does!”

We help you stand out from your competitors (rather than stand up to them) by working as an exceptional “business partner” rather than an efficient “supplier”

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